

UXPlore: High Fidelity Prototype

Team UXplore

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UX Project Slide deck

High-Fidelity Prototype Link:

<https://www.canva.com/design/DAGi2KXUp2g/UmsqsZatZfUbKGENYa4kcA/view?mode=prototype>

User Tasks:

- Find the Barcelona featured program using Quick Search
 - Find financial details about the program
- Use the search filters to find a program in Austria
- Make an advising appointment
- Find information about study abroad scholarships





Executive summary

Problems with Current Site

- **Information overload:** Users reported feeling "lost and overwhelmed" by too much content
- **Hidden scholarship info:** Financial details are "difficult to locate and understand"
- **Outdated design:** 4 of 10 students cited outdated design as reason for distrust



Our Solutions

- **Single unified search** replacing confusing 3-tab system
- **Scholarship information** prominently displayed on every program page
- **Modern visual design** with program images and clear hierarchy



Context

- **Tasks Focused on:**
 - Find a program by country
 - Locate advising or scholarship information
 - Applying a search filter
- **Why?**
 - These were the most important and most frustrating tasks for students. Users often gave up and asked an advisor instead.
- **Who we Studied:**
 - Phase 1: 4 CIE faculty members and 6 NAU students
 - Phase 2: 8 NAU students - 4 per prototype



UX Design Issue #1: Search

Overwhelming & confusing search experience:

- **3 search tabs**
 - Simple
 - Advanced
 - Map
- **Advanced by default**
- **Unnecessary/broken filters**

Why does it matter?

- **Users have to guess/troubleshoot the interface**

Programs : Search (advanced) Simple Search Advanced Search Map Search

The boxes below allow you to search for programs by using one or more criteria. To select multiple criteria from within one box hold the Ctrl key while clicking on the different options. ✕

Program Search

Program Name:

Show: Outbound ▾

Location and Term

Region Any ▾
Africa
Asia
Australia/Pacific Islands

Country Any ▾
Argentina
Australia
Austria
Belgium

Term Any ▾
Academic Year
Calendar Year
Fall
Spring

Partner Institution(s):



UX Design Issue #2: Design

Cluttered & outdated design:

- Text-heavy & “Bare bones”
- Poor visual hierarchy
- Outdated = user distrust
- Users avoid the site, default to advisor meeting

Why does it matter?

- First impressions matter
- Current design discourages exploration

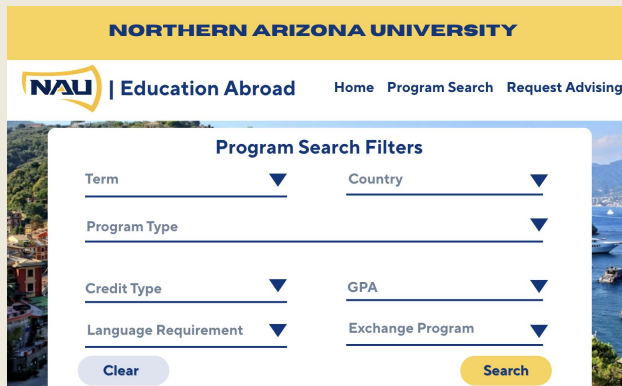
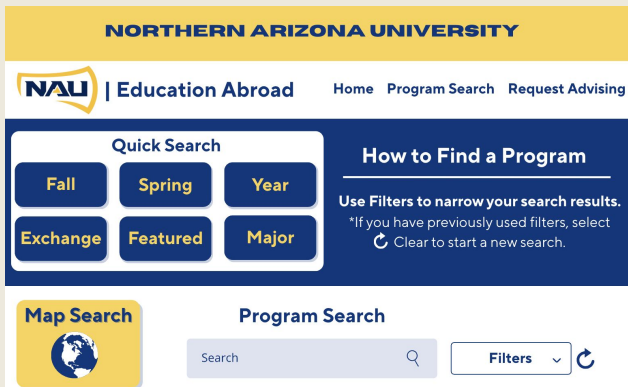
Program search results				
Program Name ↑	City	Country	Region	Save/Share
*CCC Students Only** NAU and CCC in Spain: Social Entrepreneurship and Culture in Cuenca (Thomas & Heiser)	Cuenca	Spain	Europe	 
Absolute Internship - Virtual International Internships	Flagstaff, AZ	U.S., Canada, and U.S. Territories	North America	 
Absolute Internship in Barcelona, Spain (Provider)	Barcelona	Spain	Europe	
Absolute Internship in Beijing (Provider)	Beijing	China	Asia	
Absolute Internship in Hong Kong, SAR of China (Provider)	Hong Kong	China	Asia	
Absolute Internship in Lisbon, Portugal (Provider)	Lisbon	Portugal	Europe	
Absolute Internship in London, United Kingdom (Provider)	London	United Kingdom	Europe	
Absolute Internship in Madrid, Spain (Provider)	Madrid	Spain	Europe	
Absolute Internship in Paris, France (Provider)	Paris	France	Europe	
Absolute Internship in Seoul, South Korea (Provider)	Seoul	South Korea	Asia	
Absolute Internship in Shanghai, China (Provider)	Shanghai	China	Asia	
Absolute Internship in Singapore (Provider)	Singapore	Singapore	Asia	
Absolute Internship in Stockholm, Sweden (Provider)	Stockholm	Sweden	Europe	



UX Design Recommendations

Action 1: Unified Search System

- Replace 3 search interfaces with one main search
- Add Quick Search buttons for most common needs: Summer, Semester, All Programs
- Create clear filters: Location, Duration, Major, Cost
- Include program previews with image thumbnails in results





UX Design Recommendations

Action 2: Visual Featured Programs

- Display top 6 programs with destination imagery on homepage
- Include cost estimates and scholarship availability upfront
- Show program duration and major compatibility





UX Design Recommendations

Action 3: Advisor Access & Scholarships

- Add prominent "Talk to an Advisor" button in Quick Links sidebar
- Display scholarship eligibility on program detail pages
- Create dedicated "Finances" tab for each program with cost breakdown
- Include direct scheduling tool for advisor appointments





THANKS FOR LISTENING!!!

